12.6 Head and Neck Cancer

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "Food sticks in my throat; I cannot swallow solids." **Objective** • Lost 7 kg • Coughs on thin fluids • Tumour in the oropharynx	**ACTUAL** **Impaired swallowing** related to tumour obstruction and treatment effects as evidenced by dysphagia and coughing with fluids.	Gets enough nutrition by a safe route and keeps his weight steady.	• Arrange a swallow assessment with the speech therapist. • Give a texture-modified diet and thickened fluids as recommended. • Give tube feeds if ordered. • Weigh once a week and refer to the dietitian.	Weight steady, eating safely: **goal met**.
Subjective • "I do not want people to see my face." **Objective** • Face changed after surgery • Does not want visitors	**ACTUAL** **Disturbed body image** related to facial disfigurement as evidenced by avoiding visitors and distress.	Talks about how he feels and lets the family visit.	• Let him talk about how he feels. • Prepare the family for how he looks. • Talk about reconstructive and prosthetic options. • Refer for psychological support.	Accepts visits: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Had surgery and radiation to the pharynx • Weak cough	**RISK** **Risk for aspiration** as evidenced by risk factors: impaired swallowing and altered anatomy.	No aspiration.	• Sit him up for every meal and for 30 minutes after. • Keep suction available. • Watch for fever, cough and chest signs.	No aspiration: **goal met**.